

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 481

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Robert Earl "Bobby"
Duke of Dickson.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Robert Earl "Bobby" Duke of Dickson; and

WHEREAS, Bobby Duke was a man of faith who loved his family and the outdoors and led by example, enriching the lives of all who were fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, a native and lifelong resident of Dickson, Mr. Duke was born on February 2, 1938, to Marvin and Lorelle Johnson Duke; and

WHEREAS, Bobby Duke dedicated his early years to working as a community butcher and farmer alongside his family; he later made his living as a factory manager at Schrader Valve and Quebecor Printing; and

WHEREAS, he was also a Community Beautification Expert, winning numerous awards for his meticulously maintained lawn and taking it upon himself to care for several public flower beds throughout Dickson, leaving the town more vibrant and beautiful for all who live there; and

WHEREAS, Bobby Duke was an active and devout member of both Rock Church of Christ and Walnut Street Church of Christ; he took great pride in serving as president of the Rock Church Cemetery Association, ensuring the cemetery's care and preservation for generations to come; and

WHEREAS, he was also deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Duke's legacy is carried on by his wife of nearly sixty-five years, Wilma Maxine Woodard Duke; children, Robert Perry (Jena) Duke, Vandy (Sharon) Duke, and Cherie (Doug) Welch; grandchildren, Scarlet Bryant, Johnathan Duke, Brooke Duke Houschildt,

Stephen Duke, Anastasia Duke, Andrew Welch, Jacey Duke, and Alexander Welch; and great-grandchildren, Lorelai Bryant, Kayden Bryant, Harbor Duke, Allie Houschildt, Vladimir Collette, Mila Duke, Daxton Houschildt, Arya Collette, and Eloise Duke; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his brothers, Larry Duke, Jimmy Duke, and Clark Duke; and

WHEREAS, Bobby Duke leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Robert Earl "Bobby" Duke, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Duke.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.